StudyVance AI Academy

Proposed course programme for Grade 4 to Grade 12

Purpose of the academy

We propose a practical AI learning programme under StudyVance that helps learners understand artificial intelligence, ask better questions, check information and use AI responsibly for learning and creating. The programme builds on StudyVance's study skills focus, with guided activities and projects suited to each age group.

The recommended starting point is a small, in-person beginner pilot for two groups: Grade 4 to 6 and Grade 7 to 12. Five proposed skill levels give learners a pathway from discovery to independent project work. Dates, fees and selected tools remain to be confirmed.

Who the programme is for

Learners from Grade 4 upwards, including complete beginners. Place learners in similar age groups, then advance them according to demonstrated skills. Older beginners should cover the foundations through age-appropriate activities.

What learners should gain

- An understanding of what AI can do and why its answers can be wrong.
- The ability to write clear instructions, review outputs and improve them.
- Practical ways to use AI for explanations, practice and creative projects.
- Confidence in checking facts, protecting privacy and explaining their own contribution.

Proposed skill levels

Level 1 AI Explorers

Suggested audience: Grade 4 to 6 beginners.

Discover AI through teacher-led activities. Practise giving clear instructions, spotting mistakes and protecting personal information.

Final project: Plan an illustrated story through guided group activities.

Level 2 AI Creators

Suggested audience: Grade 7 to 9 beginners and younger learners who have completed Level 1.

Improve prompts, compare outputs, edit writing and plan posters or presentations. Adapt delivery to each learner’s age and permitted tool access.

Final project: Create a campaign for an imaginary school event.

Level 3 AI Study Skills

Suggested audience: Grade 7 to 12 after foundations.

Request explanations and hints, create practice questions, check summaries against supplied notes and plan revision. Demonstrate understanding without AI afterwards.

Final project: Create and test a study pack from supplied class notes.

Level 4 AI Problem Solvers

Suggested audience: Grade 8 to 12 with intermediate skills.

Break problems into steps, verify research claims, interpret simple data and explore introductory coding.

Final project: Design a solution to a school or community problem.

Level 5 AI Innovators

Suggested audience: Grade 10 to 12 with advanced skills.

Develop a project brief, build and test a prototype, evaluate limitations and present the outcome.

Final project: Produce a simple working prototype or business concept.

Six session beginner course

Suggested format: six weekly sessions of 60 to 75 minutes. Each session combines a short explanation, a guided activity and a brief reflection. Use Afrikaans or English activities according to the group's needs.

Week	Focus	Activity and outcome
1	Meet AI	Explore what AI can and cannot do. Agree on class rules and identify examples of unreliable answers.
2	Ask better questions	Add context, instructions and examples. Compare vague and clear prompts and explain why results differ.
3	AI detective	Find mistakes in prepared answers. Check claims against trusted sources and supplied learning material.
4	Create something	Plan a story, poster or presentation. Review the first result and make deliberate improvements.
5	Learn with AI	Use explanations, hints and practice questions. Complete a short independent task to check understanding.
6	Project presentation	Present a small project, describe AI assistance and explain the learner's own decisions and changes.

Study skills activities

This can become a signature part of the academy. Learners practise asking for help that supports understanding, then demonstrate what they have learned independently.

- Give me a hint before showing the answer.
- Ask me one question at a time to test my understanding.
- Explain this at Grade 6 level, then let me try an example.
- Check my method and help me find where I went wrong.

Responsible use and age appropriate delivery

Responsible use should be taught throughout the programme. Learners should avoid sharing personal information, question confident answers, acknowledge AI assistance and follow their school's rules for assignments. Use fictional or anonymised examples in class.

For ChatGPT, children under 13 should participate through adult-led educational activities, with the adult conducting the actual interaction. Learners aged 13 to 17 need parental permission. Check the current requirements of every selected tool before enrolment and use; grade alone does not establish eligibility.

Younger groups can use prompt cards, printed examples, teacher demonstrations and collaborative planning. Older eligible learners can practise directly with approved tools under supervision.

Assessment and learner portfolio

Assess the learner's thinking as well as the finished project. Look for clear instructions, checks for accuracy, purposeful improvements and an explanation of their own contribution. A short independent task helps establish whether learning has taken place.

Suggested learner materials include a workbook, an activity portfolio and a final project. A StudyVance completion certificate can recognise participation and demonstrated skills; it should not imply an accredited qualification.

Recommended pilot plan

- Run Level 1 first with separate Grade 4 to 6 and Grade 7 to 12 beginner groups.
- Prepare six lesson plans, a learner workbook and a short parent information sheet.
- Confirm devices, internet access, approved tools, parental permissions and the teacher-led arrangements for younger learners.
- Collect learner and parent feedback and review project quality before developing the next levels.
- Use the pilot to set fees, class size and the format of any later online course.

Proposed parent message

Help your child understand AI, use it responsibly and develop practical skills for learning and creating. StudyVance AI Academy is a proposed programme for learners from Grade 4 upwards, with age-appropriate activities and a pathway through different skill levels.

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Reference for tool age requirements

OpenAI Help Center — Is ChatGPT safe for all ages? https://help.openai.com/en/articles/8313401-is-chatgpt-safe-for-all-ages (checked 13 October 2026). Requirements should be rechecked before launch.